coast. The effects of El Niño in South America are direct and stronger than in North America. An El Niño is associated with warm and very wet weather months in April-October along the coasts of northern Peru and Ecuador, causing major flooding whenever the event is strong or extreme. The effects during the months of February, March, and April may become critical along the west coast of South America, El Niño reduces the upwell- ing of cold, nutrient-rich water that sustains large fish populations, which in turn sustain abundant sea birds, whose droppings support the fertilizer industry. The reduction in upwelling leads to fish kills off the shore of Peru.

68. Nature reserves, established to protect animals in their habitat, are now found in most South American countries. Argentina pioneered wildlife protection on the continent by creating Nahuel Huapí National Park. At Iguagu Falls-located on the Iguagu River on the border between Brazil and Argentina, just before the confluence of the Iguagu and Paraná rivers-two national parks, one in each country, protect wildlife and the surrounding rainforest. Manu National Park in southeastern Peru protects one of the richest collections of plant and animal life in the Amazon basin, including more than 1000 species of birds. Venezuela's effort to protect habitats led to the establishment (1962) of Canaima National Park in the Guiana Highlands, which with an area of nearly 11,600 square miles is the largest park on the continent.

69. Argentina and Chile share significant oil deposits bordering the Strait of Magellan in Patagonia and Tierra del Fuego.

South America contains about one-fifth of the world's iron ore reserves. The most important beds are located in Brazil and Venezuela, supplying domestic iron and steel industries as well as significant exports. The great majority of the continent's reserves are in the Brazilian states of Minas Gerais, Pará, and Mato Grosso do Sul, where lodes of magnetite and hematite ores contain up to 50 to 65% iron content. In Venezuela, sites like Mount Bolívar and El Pao in the Sierra de Imataca at the base of the Guiana Highlands have reserves of ore containing a high percentage of iron.